

## Features and benefits of using repository software

- Fine-grained access control
- Integrated data storage and full data API
- Federated structure: One can easily set up new instances with common search
- Complete catalogue system with easy-to-use Web interface and a powerful API
- Strong integration with third-party CMS like Drupal and WordPress
- Data visualisation and analytics
- Workflow support lets departments or groups manage and publish their own data
- Often provides more digital preservation tools or integration with such tools (file format validation/verification, integrity checking, integration with anti-virus software, etc)
- Often provides persistent URLs (handles, DOIs and/or PURL.s) for all digital content to help ensure long-term access
- Tends to follow latest library and archival best practices in relation to metadata (Dublin Core, MODS, METS, etc), digital preservation (OAIS, TRAC, PREMIS, etc), and interoperability (OAI-PMH, SWORD protocol, OAI-ORE, etc)
- Often better at long-term preservation and access of finished or published documents
- Scholarly communication
- Stores learning material and course ware
- Enables electronic publishing
- Manages collections of research documents
- Preserves digital materials for the long term
- Adds to the university's prestige by showcasing its academic research
- Gives an institutional leadership role to the library
- Simplifies knowledge management
- Enables research assessment
- Encourages open access to scholarly research
- Houses digitised collections
- Each university has a unique culture and assets that require a customised approach. The information model that best suits your university would not fit another campus

## Examples of repositories with a CMS

- Islandora: Built on the Drupal CMS platform and stores its content in a Fedora repository
- Drupal's DSpace module allows one to pull DSpace

repository content or metadata into a Drupal CMS

- Joomla's DSpace module (J-CAR) allows one to pull DSpace repository content or metadata into a Joomla CMS

## Support for various file formats

- Text (documents, theses, books)
- Images
- Datasets
- Video
- Audio
- Computer programs
- CAD/CAM
- Databases
- Complex/multi-part items

## Systems administration features

- User management
- Adjustable user permissions
- Supports user authentication (x.509 or LDAP)
- Registration, roles-based security, authentication, authorisation, etc.
- Reporting features
- Logging features
- Scalability
- Clustering with automatic fail over
- Backup and recovery

## Benefits of repositories for institutions

- Opens up outputs of the institution to a worldwide audience
- Maximises the visibility and impact of these outputs
- Showcases the institution to interested constituencies – prospective staff, prospective students and other stakeholders
- Collects and curates digital output
- Manages and measures research and teaching activities
- Provides a workspace for work-in-progress and for collaborative or large-scale projects
- Enables and encourages interdisciplinary approaches to research
- Facilitates the development and sharing of digital teaching materials and aids
- Supports student endeavours, providing access to theses and dissertations and a location for the development of e-portfolios

## CKAN

**URL:** <http://www.ckan.org/>

CKAN is a powerful data management system that provides the tools to streamline publishing, sharing, finding and use data. CKAN is aimed at data publication agencies (national and

regional governments, companies and organisations) willing to make their data open and available. CKAN is open source and can be downloaded free without any restrictions. The users can get hosting and support from a range of suppliers. A full-time professional development team at the Open